

Redevelopment Commission Meeting May 14th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tkHbYuGsTgc
Publication Date	2026-05-14T02:14:35Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

No statutory public hearings or committee work sessions were held immediately prior to the regular meeting.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the meeting to order following the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Whitehead, Mr. Hans, Mr. Christy, Mr. Buffalo, Mr. Brook (Note: Board members/commissioners also referenced or participating include Mr. Gibson, Mr. Hamilton, and the Surveyor/Tom Blair).
 - **Members Absent:** *None explicitly stated.*
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named in opening dialogue, but leading procedural actions.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the April 8th meeting were approved following a motion and proper second, passed by voice vote (roll call vote was called and recorded as

affirmative).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:00:54 Tabled Business: Banning Engineer Report for Drainage Board**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Surveyor / Tom Blair.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding whether Banning Engineering representatives would attend the open house. The report was kept under review for ongoing drainage board considerations.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Held over / continued discussion.
 - **00:31:46 New Business: Ashton Land Surveyor <U+2013> Request for Right-of-Way Reduction**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kathy (Ashton Land Surveyors) / Mr. Surveyor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Kathy requested a reduction of the 75-foot setback to approximately 20.61 feet on the south side of Brown Ditch (a buried tile located near 501 North Northwood Drive) to accommodate pre-existing duplex structures being platted into individual lots. The Surveyor noted that access to the north side of the tile would remain open and gave a favorable recommendation. Tommy Hbert from the highway department also noted an upcoming structure cleaning nearby.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Motion carried unanimously).
 - **00:35:58 New Business: Vacation Request for Tile/Ditch near US 35 South & County Road 709 South**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Surveyor / Rez Company representative.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A private company ("Rez") proposed vacating a regulated tile drain and converting it into an open, natural wetland/mitigation area to capture nutrients before reaching Prairie Creek. The Surveyor raised concerns about loss of drainage board access, potential downstream blockages (beaver dams, log jams), and lack of upstream landowner concurrence. Board members agreed that vacating without guarantees or upstream approval would harm landowners to the south.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to deny the vacation request passed unanimously by roll call vote.
 - **00:49:57 Approval of Maintenance Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Mr. Surveyor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of maintenance claims. A correction was requested for Claim 7508 (Hog Creek / All Creek nomenclature adjustments).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:01:44 Andrew Crook** (6401 South Proctor Road, Muncie)
Expressed frustration regarding an incomplete brush and tree clearing project along the "no-name creek" started in late summer/fall 2025. Notified the board about heavy equipment damaging fences without warning, a large dead ash tree falling across the creek post-project, and inadequate cleanup preventing lawn mower access. *Note: Surveyor Tom Blair and contractor Jiren Crabtree (JJC Excavating) responded that a work order was issued on May 6, 2026, to clean up remaining debris and remove the fallen tree under warranty.*
- **00:13:11 Cody Light** (9800 North County Road 525 West, Gaston)
Addressed ongoing flooding issues concerning the Rector Drain. Stated the drain is over capacity and past its working life, causing severe back-ups and flooding on his property and neighbor Tim Hollingsworth's land near McCallum Road. Discussed potential solutions including raising riser pipes or evaluating full reconstruction.
- **00:20:55 Richard Hawk** (1000 North Claypool Road)
Sought permission to install a culvert in Holt Ditch to create a driveway access to the north side of his property, noting his neighbor to the east is attempting to landlock him. The Surveyor agreed to re-evaluate the site and culvert size.
- **00:23:36 Rick Answer** (3100 North 500 West)
Expressed concerns regarding a newly built pole barn between the old acute schoolhouse and Gil Brothers, noting a lack of drainage remedies. Highlighted historical issues with overflowing subdivision retention ponds and broken down drainage tiles during heavy rains.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Debrushing & Contract Enforcement:** Discussion regarding contractor timelines, weather delays, and potential additions of penalty clauses (such as holding 20% retainage until cleanup is complete) in future debrushing contracts.
 - **Vegetative Barriers:** The board discussed establishing low-maintenance vegetative barriers and mowing/spraying plans following debrushing projects.
 - **Storm Water Meeting Rescheduling:** The upcoming combined stormwater/drainage board meeting was shifted from June 1st to June 10th.
 - **Board of Finance:** Commissioner announcements noted a County Board of Finance meeting scheduled for the following Monday at 10:30 AM.

- **Open House (McConnell Reconstruction):** Preparations and landowner notifications are underway for an open house regarding the McConnell reconstruction project at the next meeting.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was concluded and adjourned via voice vote.
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